Core Design System 2.0

Mayes Digital Production Framework

> **Core Design System 2.0 should become Mayes Digital's actual production framework, not another website template. ProofBook and ServicePro have exposed exactly what needs to be standardized.**

The fundamental change is separating **structure, layout, design tokens, components, and client branding** so the same problems are not solved differently on every design.

1. Page Architecture

Every major page section should follow the same structural pattern:

```
Section
Padding
Container
Component / Layout
```

Section

- Controls background color or image
- Controls overflow and section-level positioning when required
- Carries theme/context
- Defaults to display: block unless structure requires otherwise

Padding

Controls horizontal page gutters only. It should not control backgrounds, max-widths, grids, component spacing, or unrelated layout decisions.

Container

- Controls content max-width
- Uses width: 100%
- Centers page content

Component / Layout

- Controls grid or flex layout
- Controls internal gaps and alignment
- Owns component-specific responsive behavior

Vertical section spacing should use standardized section-spacing utilities attached to the Section rather than arbitrary padding values.

```
section + section-space-large
section + section-space-medium
section + section-space-small
```

2. Global Design Tokens

Spacing

Core 2.0 should replace arbitrary spacing values with a defined scale and semantic variables.

```
space-0
space-2xs
space-xs
space-small
space-medium
space-large
space-xl
space-2xl
space-3xl

section-space-small
section-space-medium
section-space-large
component-gap-small
component-gap-medium
component-gap-large
page-gutter
```

Container widths

```
container-small
container-medium
container-large
container-xlarge
container-full
```

Most normal content should use one default container. Avoid numerous slightly different max-widths created for individual sections.

3. Responsive System

Design intentionally across Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Landscape, and Mobile Portrait. Core 2.0 establishes common behavior before client design begins.

```
4-column
Desktop: 4
Tablet: 2
Mobile landscape: 1 or 2
Mobile portrait: 1

3-column
Desktop: 3
Tablet: 2
Mobile: 1

Split
Desktop: 1fr 1fr
Tablet: 1fr 1fr or stacked
Mobile: stacked
```

Use standardized layout primitives instead of repairing every card collection independently.

4. Typography System

Core establishes typography roles, not client fonts.

```
Heading Display
Heading H1
```

```
Heading H2
Heading H3
Heading H4

Body Large
Body
Body Small

Eyebrow
Label
Caption
Utility
Button
Navigation
```

Each client design maps its brand fonts onto these roles. The system standardizes how typography works without forcing Mayes Digital's typography onto clients.

5. Color Architecture

Use semantic roles rather than design-specific color names.

```
background-primary
background-secondary
background-inverse

text-primary
text-secondary
text-muted
text-inverse

border-primary
border-subtle

brand-primary
brand-secondary
accent
```

Each design maps its own palette to these semantic roles, making components easier to reuse.

6. Surface System

Standardize recurring visual treatments rather than rebuilding them ad hoc.

```
Radius Small
Radius Medium
Radius Large
Radius XL
Radius Pill

Border Subtle
Border Strong

Shadow Small
Shadow Medium
Shadow Large

Glass Surface
Elevated Surface
Card Surface
```

7. Layout Primitives

Core 2.0 should provide reusable structural primitives.

```
layout-grid-2
layout-grid-3
layout-grid-4

layout-split
layout-stack

cluster
stack
sidebar
```

Avoid creating separate pricing-grid, service-grid, features-grid classes when the underlying structural behavior is shared.

8. Component Library

Global

```
Navbar
Footer
Button
Icon Button
Logo
Breadcrumb
```

Content

```
Section Heading
Eyebrow
Feature Card
Service Card
Testimonial Card
Pricing Card
FAQ Item
Stat
Badge
Icon + Text
```

Conversion

```
CTA
Contact Form
Lead Form
Booking CTA
```

Media

```
Image
Image Frame
Browser Frame
Device Frame
Gallery
Before / After
Video
```

Navigation / Interaction

```
Tabs
Accordion
```

```
Dropdown
Slider
Lightbox
```

Whenever Webflow provides a quality native implementation, Core 2.0 should default to native Webflow functionality.

9. Component Props

Props should control content and legitimate client-level variation, not arbitrary design decisions.

Good props

```
Heading
Description
Image
Image Alt
Button Label
Button Link
Eyebrow
Badge
Feature 1
Feature 2
Theme Variant
```

Avoid

```
Padding = 63px
Border Radius = 17px
Heading Color = #...
Gap = 37px
Shadow = ...
```

Decision rule: Would this reasonably change when adapting the component for another client? If yes, consider a prop. If it is part of how Mayes Digital builds consistently, it belongs in Core.

10. Standard Section Patterns

Create approved production-ready compositions rather than client-specific designs.

```
Hero / Split
Hero / Centered
Hero / Visual

Features / 3 Card
Features / 4 Card

Services / Grid
Services / Alternating

Proof / Gallery
Proof / Before After
Proof / Testimonials

Process / Steps
Pricing / Cards
FAQ / Two Column
FAQ / Single Column
CTA / Split
CTA / Centered
Contact / Form
```

ProofBook and ServicePro can use different combinations of the same underlying system while remaining visually distinct.

11. Accessibility Built Into Core

- Correct semantic HTML
- Heading hierarchy rules
- Keyboard navigation
- Visible focus states
- Sufficient touch targets
- Form labels and accessible error states
- Descriptive alt-text architecture
- Appropriate ARIA where native HTML is insufficient
- Reduced-motion consideration
- Contrast-safe token combinations

Accessibility should be inherited from Core components, not discovered only during the final audit.

12. Interaction System

Standardize motion patterns instead of adding random interactions.

```
Reveal
Fade
Rise
Scale
Stagger
Image Reveal
Accordion
Navigation

duration-fast
duration-normal
duration-slow

ease-standard
ease-enter
ease-exit
```

Native Webflow first. GSAP when justified. Custom JavaScript last.

13. CMS Architecture

Core 2.0 should establish reusable CMS patterns without forcing every collection into every website.

```
Services
Projects
Testimonials
Team
Locations
Resources
Website Designs
Plans
```

```
FAQs
```

Example Services schema

```
Name
Slug
Short Description
Long Description
Hero Image
Card Image
SEO Title
SEO Description
Featured
Order
```

Field naming and architecture should be standardized so new projects do not require a fresh CMS schema every time.

14. SEO System

- One clear H1
- Logical H2/H3 structure
- Internal-link opportunities
- Image alt-text support
- SEO title
- Meta description
- OG title
- OG description
- OG image
- Canonical strategy
- Schema where appropriate

CMS templates should include SEO fields from the beginning.

15. Forms

Core should contain real production form patterns using native Webflow forms as the baseline.

```
Contact Form
Lead Form
Quote Form
Booking Form
Newsletter Form
```

GoHighLevel or another platform becomes an integration layer rather than something the structural design depends on.

16. Core Pages

```
Home / System Overview
Style Guide
Components
Patterns
CMS Examples
```

```
Forms
Instructions
Accessibility
SEO
Licenses / Internal Asset Register
```

The Style Guide becomes the visual control center rather than a leftover documentation page.

17. Build Workflow

```
CORE DESIGN SYSTEM 2.0
|
Duplicate
|
Apply Brand
|
Choose Patterns
|
Configure Components
|
Add Client Content
|
Configure CMS
|
QA
|
Launch
```

This replaces the pattern of starting from a blank project, building ad hoc, repairing tablet/mobile afterward, and accumulating custom CSS.

Completion Gate

- Finsweet Client-First: structure and naming
- Apple Human Interface Guidelines: interaction quality and usability
- Webflow Marketplace quality standards: general technical-quality benchmark with documented client-site exceptions
- Four-breakpoint responsive QA: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Landscape, Mobile Portrait
- Mayes Digital checks: Accessibility, SEO, Performance, Native Webflow preference, Component integrity, CMS integrity

The Biggest Architectural Change

> **Core 1.0 was essentially a starting website. Core Design System 2.0 should be a website-building operating system.**

ProofBook and ServicePro become implementations of that system rather than templates that slowly develop their own rules.

ProofBook should be finished under its existing architecture because it is already close to Mayes Digital client-ready. Core 2.0 becomes the foundation for design #3 forward, with worthwhile improvements selectively migrated back into ProofBook and ServicePro.

Improvement / Risk

The biggest danger is overbuilding Core 2.0 into hundreds of utilities and variants. Standardize the 80% repeatedly used while preserving the remaining 20% for intentional design differentiation.